

Narayan Ashanahalli



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Designer

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Hi I'm product prototyper working across human-AI interaction & AI native tool-building. I design and build end-to-end, from research, interaction models and visual craft to shipped tools, prototypes, and full-stack platforms. Looking to join a lean, technical team building for, and truly caring about, the "future of human-AI collaboration".

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University Masters in Advanced Architecture Design	2024 — 2026
Jawaharlal Nehru Architecture & Fine Arts University Bachelor in Architecture	2018 — 2023

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Product Designer | Dot Threads

- Designed and shipped Dot Threads, a Chrome extension that turns saved links into a spatial graph, helping users organize, edit and share research by context and relationships, alternative to the traditional bookmarking.
- Validated the workflow through 25 user interviews across 3 CMU departments and shipped a 4-click save flow with right-click capture, contextual tagging, and graph-based retrieval, live on the Web Store with 10+ active users.

Interaction Designer | Pointobot

- Built a 2-DOF laser mechanism (lab assistant) with voice input and LLM-based spatial reasoning — physically pointing to real-world locations in a shared lab environment as a primary communication channel.
- Investigated pointing and deceits as an interaction paradigm for HALL — designing for a world where AI references physical space directly rather than describing it through language.
- Developed a responsive gesture library for communicating robot state through physical movement, removing the need for screen or voice output for a lab prototype currently used by 15+ students daily.

Interaction Designer | Piko

- Designed a soft robotic companion detecting doom-scrolling posture with 91% accuracy using a custom-trained computer vision model, delivering peripheral physical feedback as a habit-building nudge.
- Developed an emotive gesture library translating 4 behavioral states into physical servo movements — curiosity, joy, shyness, anger — creating social feedback without language.
- Trained a custom CV model on 600+ images using Roboflow, to detect doom-scrolling posture and trigger real-time physical feedback through across a 3-node Raspberry Pi architecture for low-latency, accurate real-time response.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lab for Cybernetics

Design Researcher

Dec 2024 — current

- Led the design and full-stack development of the Lab for Cybernetics' digital platform, replacing fragmented Google Docs and Notion workflows with a modular Notion-based CMS, increasing user participation by 80%.
- Shipped an OTP-secured AI matchmaking feature for 25+ practitioners and scholars, using profile submissions, research interests, expertise, AI-generated topic chips, and match reasoning to recommend relevant collaborators.
- Implemented the platform with Next.js/TypeScript frontend, Notion API, and Gmail SMTP, with modular CMS workflows and dev-documentation for future maintainers and non-technical content updates.

Studio Chintala

Project Designer

Aug 2023 — July 2024

- Led research, concept development, and delivery of Working, Living & Innovating, translating behavioral field user research across an industrial campus into a phased design strategy that secured \$10,000 Phase I approval.
- Developed a systems-based intervention framework across 5 spatial domains, presenting cost-tiered prototypes to stakeholders and driving alignment between worker experience goals and operational constraints.
- Produced environmental graphics for Shell Corporation: executed 8'x8' interactive way-finding installation and 400+ sqft of laser-cut acrylic branding across 6 employee break-rooms, serving 200+ daily users.
- Initial design and drawings for a 60,000 SQFT office interior renovation
- Managed the design, production, and manufacturing of industrial design development for the firm's product line, Be.Liv.

Nelson WW

Visual Designer

Dec 2023 — July 2024

- Contributed to revamped presentation system and stakeholder portfolio templates for business development across multiple industry verticals. (Nelson Worldwide, sister firm to Studio Chintala)

Uniworks Design

Machine Learning Intern

Aug 2020 — Jan 2021

- Contributed to ArP-Gen, a machine learning project automating architectural floor plan generation

SKILLS

Design

Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Visual Design, Rapid Prototyping, Design Systems, User Testing, Systems Thinking, Micro-interaction Design, Human-AI Interaction, Conversation Design

Tools

Figma, FigJam, Framer, Miro, Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects, Indesign, Adobe XD, Notion, ProtoPie, Procreate, Xcode, Heap, Hotjar, Userlytics, GitHub, Rhino 3D, Blender

Technical

HTML, CSS, React, TypeScript, Python, API Integration, Version Control (Git), SQL, MCP, AI-assisted coding with Cursor, Claude Code